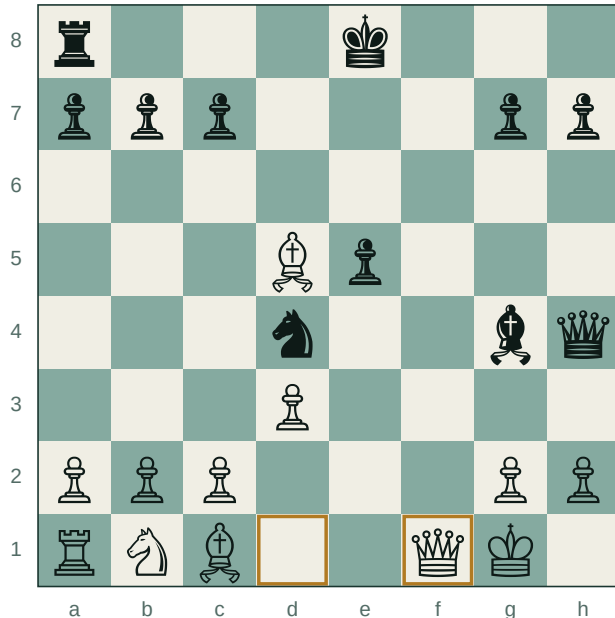


Kingside attacks: Black, move 16

Kingside attacks

Black to move



Previous move: 16.Qf1. Gold borders mark its start and finish.

WORKED CONTINUATION - COVER THIS SECTION FIRST

16...Ne2+ 17. Qxe2 Bxe2

16...Ne2+ Check restricts White to 2 legal replies here. From e2 it attacks king on g1 and bishop on c1. Recorded reply: **17.Qxe2**.

17...Bxe2 The bishop captures the queen on e2.

At the end, nominal material is White 20 / Black 23 (P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9). Over this line, Black's balance changes by +6. Activity and king safety still affect the evaluation.

CHECKPOINT

Using P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9, how much does Black's material balance change over the complete line? **Answer:** +6: the balance goes from -3 to +3. Count promotions and every recapture, not just the first gain.

CARRY THE IDEA INTO YOUR GAMES

Do not count distant pieces as attackers unless they can reach useful squares in time. Every preparatory move gives the defender a turn.

WHAT THIS POSITION TEACHES

A kingside attack succeeds when pieces and pawn breaks create concrete threats near the king. The attack must arrive before the defender can exchange attackers or counter in the center.

HOW TO LOOK

Count the pieces that can join immediately, identify an entry square, and calculate the defender's checks and exchanges.

The defending king is on g1. Geometrically undefended: bishop on d5 and rook on a1. Check for tactical protection.